

A Deal With Rufus Furbles

Written by
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(Printed with the demonstration version of Fade In)

INT. LISA'S DORM - NIGHT

In a ~~small studio apartment~~, ADAM sits on an air mattress on the floor while his twin sister LISA types rapidly on her computer. Adam, 19 years old, wears a white button up shirt with the sleeves rolled up and his hair is neatly combed back. Lisa's bright green hair and colorful clothes stand out in the otherwise neutral colored scene.

Adam goes over a script while mumbling the words to himself. He looks up at Lisa, when he sees she is still working, he goes back to his script. He reads a few more words and looks at the time on his phone.

ADAM

Lis! you said you would help me
rehearse this scene, dude. Do you
think you'll be done soon?

- a. complain
- b. do not complain

Lisa looks up from her computer but does not turn to look at Adam. She sighs and rubs her face annoyed.

LISA

I'll be done whenever I'm done. Some
of us are still in school, remember?

Lisa, immediately regretting her words, turns to look at her ~~friend~~.

LISA (cont'd)

Ok, that was mean. I'm sorry. It's
just with finals and everything...

ADAM

Hey, it's ok. I'm the one that's
sorry. You are nice enough to let me
crash here until I tell mom I dropped
out. I'm just so nervous.

- a. tell mom
- b. do not tell

Lisa smiles sympathetically and closes her laptop.

LISA

And-- when exactly are you planning
on telling her? ~~It's been two months~~
~~Adam.~~

- a. ask
- b. do not ask
- a. judge/ annoyed
- b. be sympathetic

Adam looks at Lisa but does not answer. The girl laughs awkwardly.

LISA (cont'd)

Do you really think it's going to be
that bad? (sympathetic)

ADAM

Oh, I don't think it's going to be a.it IS that bad!
that bad. I know it will be.

Adam lays down on the bed covering his face with the script.
He uncovers his face and stares at the ceiling..

ADAM (cont'd)

I just think if I get a role before I
tell her it will soften the blow. At b.it's not that bad
least she'll know I'm serious about
acting.

Lisa picks up a copy of the script from the bed and sits
across from him.

LISA

(Enthusiastically)

Ok, let's do this then!

She grabs Adam's hands sitting him back up, shakes him and
takes a deep breath. He takes a deep breath with her.

LISA (cont'd)

C'mon. You are going to kill it at
the audition tomorrow, then you are a. be supportive!
gonna to tell her, and before you
know we'll be sipping champagne with
Zendaya at the Oscars.

Adam laughs and picks up the script.

ADAM

Thank you! Really, for everything - I
don't know where I'd be withou-

LISA

(interrupting)

Hey, don't mention it. I'm taking b. tease
care of you, it's what older sisters
do, right?

ADAM

Ok, older for like 10 minutes, don't
push it.

LISA

Anyway, What am I reading?

ADAM

Ok, let's pick it up from "Wait, were
you planning on leaving?"

Ending #1:
Lisa is supportive,
Adams does well
at the audition.
He calls mom,
everything goes
ok.

based on Lisa's choices

If Lisa is not supportive, Adam goes nervous to the audition...

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3.

LISA
Ok. "Wait, where you planning on leaving?"

FADE OUT

FADE IN

INT. THEATER - MORNING

A nervous Adam walks in an almost empty theater. On a table facing the stage sit three people, a woman and a man in their 40s, and a young intern sitting behind them. Adam walks to the table and puts his backpack and paper coffee cup down on the floor.

ADAM
Hello everyone. Adam Coulson, nice to meet you.

Adam extends his shaky hand to the woman, she looks at it, then at him.

CASTING WOMAN
Hi, so, there is your mark.
(points to a mark on the stage)
Did you learn the lines?

ADAM
Hi, yes. Yes I did ma'am.

The woman turns to the man sitting next to her and mockingly mouths "ma'am?" with a sarcastic smirk. She looks at Adam again and gestures for him to walk on stage and shows the man something on her phone.

Adam stiffly walks to a yellow mark on the stage.

ADAM (cont'd)
Hello, everyone. My name is Adam Coulson.

The casting director continues to look at the phone.

ADAM (cont'd)
I'm 19 years old and I will be reading for the role of "guy in coffee shop."

CASTING WOMAN
Alright. "Wait, where you planning on leaving?"

Adam fists his hands and takes a deep breath. The woman looks up from her phone and locks eyes with Adam. He does not move or talk.

CASTING WOMAN (cont'd)
(sighs and clears her
throat)
"Wait, where you planning on
leaving?"

Adam opens his mouth to talk and a small squeak comes out. His face turns red.

ADAM
Uhm, wait, I can do this.

The woman rubs her forehead and takes her glasses off.

CASTING WOMAN
Look, kid, the character has four
lines. Either you know them or you
don't. Please don't waste my time.

Adam awkwardly gets his backpack and coffee and rushes out of the stage.

ADAM
I'm sorry. Sorry.

The woman whispers something to her coworker before looking at Adam.

CASTING WOMAN
Who did you say your agent was?

ADAM
Oh, I- I don't really have one yet. I
saw an ad for this on Instagram. I-

The woman rises her hand dismissively to stop Adam from continuing talking and turns to the intern.

CASTING WOMAN
(in an angry whisper)
Take. That. Fucking. Ad. Down.

He rushes to find his laptop.

INTERN
Yes. Of course, sorry. On it.

EXT. NEW YORK SIDEWALK - CONTINUOUS

Adam rushes out of a building with his phone in his hand. He is face-timing Lisa. The girl picks up.

LISA
How did it go?

ADAM
Awful, terrible, catastrophically bad.

LISA
What? Why? You were so ready yesterday. You totally embodied "guy in coffee shop."

ADAM
I know! I don't know why this keeps happening. I swear it's like my brain is trying to sabotage me or something. Every time I get in front of a casting director...

LISA
Sorry, bro.

ADAM
At this rate I might as well get ready to avoid mom forever.

LISA
Yup, you should get on that. Or... you could just tell her you dropped out. That's also always an option.

ADAM
Very funny. You know she'll drag me back to Arizona the minute she finds out her son is not only a college drop out but a college drop out that can't remember four f- freaking lines of dialogue.

LISA
You can say fuck, Adam. We're not five anymore. Reverend Paulie won't find out. He is fucking dead after all.

ADAM
Dude, don't talk like that! What did he ever do to you?

LISA

Yeah, yeah, poor Reverend Paulie. Who will brainwash ~~the~~ poor children ~~of Tempe~~ into thinking they'll go to hell for not finishing their dinner now that he's gone?

- a. defend Paulie even though you don't like him
- b. laugh

ADAM

He wasn't that bad. You just never liked church. Not Paulie's fault.

LISA

Anyway, my class is starting. See you tonight. Sorry about the audition.

ADAM

Thanks, see you.

Adam sits down on a store's window sill. He takes a sip of his coffee and looks up. When he looks up, he realizes he's sitting directly in front of a billboard of Zendaya's face. He looks at it and smiles bitterly.

ADAM (cont'd)

Sorry Zendaya, I guess you'll have to find someone else to sip champagne with.

Adam leans back on the window, closes his eyes and sighs. A well dressed man talking on his phone walks past him and without stopping casually drops a few quarters in Adam's coffee cup. The coffee spills on Adam startling him.

ADAM (cont'd)

What?

He looks down on his clothes. a. stand up for yourself
b. let it go

INT. LISA'S DORM - NIGHT

Adam scrolls through his phone looking for other auditions. Lisa sits on her bed. In her laptop, there is a Reddit thread titled "Top 10 Celebrities Who Sold Their Soul to the Devil." She laughs.

LISA

Oh my God! I'm brilliant, little brother.

Adam rolls his eyes and comes closer to Lisa.

LISA (cont'd)
(in a fake presenter
voice)
Behold the solution to all your
problems, my friend.

She turns the laptop around and shows him the article. Adam scoffs and closes the laptop.

ADAM
Really? Dude, not helping.

LISA
(Laughing)
Hey, cheer up. I'm sure you'll do
great next time. It's just a matter
of getting over the nerves.

She opens the laptop again

LISA (cont'd)
And... if that doesn't work out. We
can always...

Lisa rises her shoulders and looks suggestively at the screen.

ADAM
Stop that. That's not even true
anyway. You know that.

Lisa looks up "How to sell your soul to the devil." She opens the first result, sits up straight and starts reading in a fake serious manner.

LISA
"You'd think that at this point just
about everyone would know that a
contract with Satan isn't going to
work out the way they want it to, but
people keep doing it...."

ADAM
(getting annoyed)
Bro, why don't you help me find open
auditions instead of wasting time
with this?

a. interested
b. annoyed

Lisa laughs.

LISA
Why so scared? You said it's not true
anyway.

Lisa grabs her computer to keep reading, a gold pop up add shows up. It reads, "SELLING YOUR SOUL? GET THE BEST DEAL IN THE MARKET WITH RUFUS FURBLES' DEMON AGENCY."

LISA (cont'd)
Hey, want to be in business with
Rufus Furbles?

She laughs and clicks on the add. Adam rubs his forehead and sighs.

The lights flicker.

LISA (cont'd)
(Giggling)
Ok, how spooky is that?

A hairy little shirtless man with a curled up mustache pops up on the screen, Lisa smiles and frowns confused but intrigued.

RUFUS FURBLES
Hello young lady, looking to sell a
soul today? Buy one, maybe?...

He leans forward, his body coming out of the screen. He looks at Lisa up and down.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
Nah, you can't afford that.
Definitely selling.

A terrified Lisa squeals and drops the computer on the floor. She looks at Adam speechless.

ADAM
What?

Lisa points at the computer.

ADAM (cont'd)
Will you stop messing with me? I have
actual problems, in case you didn't
notice yet.

Lisa shakes her head.

LISA
Adam, I swear to God I'm not joking.

RUFUS FURBLES (O.S.)
Pff, to God... No one ever swears to
the man downstairs.

Adam hears the voice coming from the computer on the floor. His eyes widen as he turns to look at it.

RUFUS FURBLES (O.S.) (cont'd)

Very rude if you ask me - He for sure
does more for you humans than "~~long~~
beard man."

Adam looks at Lisa and mouths "What did you do?" Lisa shrugs.

RUFUS FURBLES (O.S.) (cont'd)

Ok, can someone pick me up? And can
someone vacuum the floor once in a
while? I'm talking to decade old lint
here.

Adam slowly approaches the computer. His hands shake as he looks at Lisa. The girl curls up on the bed. Adam grabs the computer and closes it quickly.

ADAM

What did you do? - What was that?

Lisa takes a deep breath. And shrugs.

LISA

Uhm? Probably nothing? I mean I'm
sure it's just some weird ass virus
or something.

Lisa looks at her friend. Adam's heart is still pounding.

LISA (cont'd)

That was stupid. I know. Everyone
knows you don't click the pop up ads.
But, I'm sure there is nothing to
worry about.

Lisa gets up and runs her hands through her hair. She grabs a glass of water from the night stand and takes a sip.

LISA (cont'd)

Obviously you can't sell your soul...
so I'll just have my computer checked
out in the morning. I'm sure that's
it- A virus, yes.

Adam sits down on the floor still staring at the computer.

ADAM

Lisa.

She looks at him.

LISA
(Softly)
Yes?

ADAM
I can't go to hell. Everything I've
ever done in my life I've done so I
don't end up in hell. You know that.

LISA

Ok, you know what? This is ridiculous. Let's just go to bed. It's been a long day, it's very late. We're both probably delusional at this point. I'm sure everything is fine.

She grabs the laptop from the floor.

LISA (cont'd)
Look. I'm opening it now.

Adam gets up quickly and looks around.

ADAM
(exasperated but
whispering)
Don't- No! a. do not open!!
 b. ok, let's do it together

She opens it, the screen still looks the same except for the little man, who is not there anymore. She tries exiting the page but the screen is frozen.

RUFUS FURBLES (O.S.)
(Clears throat)
That's not way to treat someone you
want to do business with.

Lisa and Adam slowly turn around and see Rufus Furbles, about five inches tall with red furry goat legs, standing in the middle of the room fixing his mustache. The little demon looks around the room in disgust.

RUFUS FURBLES
(under his breath)
What a dump.

He dusts his legs as the two friends look at each other in disbelief. Lisa leans closer to Adam's face and whispers.

Ending #2:
Adam closes the
computer and goes
to bed. He wakes
up in the morning
to a traumatized
Lisa

LISA

Do you think we can trap him like we
did that rat the other day?

a. stay quiet

b. ask silly question

Adam, still staring at the tiny red hooves, shakes his head.

~~RUFUS FURBLES~~

Doubt it.

LISA

Yep, thought so.

Rufus Furbles grows impatient as he waits for the two humans to snap out of their confusion.

RUFUS FURBLES

Alright. Who summoned me?

a. point at lisa
b. do nothing

Adam points a finger at Lisa. The girl smacks his hand and looks at him.

LISA

What the fuck, dude?

ADAM

What?- I mean you did click on the ad.

The demon pulls a clipboard out of nowhere, and puts on the smallest reading glasses Lisa and Adam have ever seen.

RUFUS FURBLES

Well...

(he studies the girl
and frowns)

Lisa? Yes, Lisa. Since you have summoned me, I now have to show you the available deals. What are you looking for? Fame, money?

Neither of the teens respond. The demon looks up from the clipboard and sighs.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)

What... you want to be skinny forever? Get a boyfriend?... a girlfriend?- No, nothing? Alright, let's see...

He flips a page on the clipboard, skims through it and flips to the next page.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)

...BBL? (chuckles) that used to be a popular one...

A frustrated Lisa looks at Adam, begging with her eyes for him to do something about the demon.

ADAM

(whispering)

This is your mess. I told you to stop- so many times.

Rufus looks at them, offended they are not listening. Lisa notices and shushes Adam.

LISA

Look, Rufus- Uhm, Mr. Furbles.
There's been a huge misunderstanding.
You see, my friend and I were just
messing around. We didn't really mean
to summon a demon, so...

a. try to reason
b. panic

Mr. Furbles takes off his glasses and interrupts the girl mid sentence.

RUFUS FURBLES

Yeah, no shit. Most people don't mean to... Hell, most of them click on the ad by accident...

(impatient)

... but you called me, now I'm here and I can't leave until one, or both, of you has signed the dotted line.

He throws his hands in the air indifferently.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)

Company policy, so... Who am I buying?

Adam turns to look Lisa in the eyes.

ADAM

(emphasizing each word)

I am going to kill you.

LISA

Well, if you kill me you'll end up in hell anyway, so might as well become a movie star instead. Right?

ADAM
(anxiously)
You are joking! How can you be joking
right now?

LISA
I don't know! I'm freaking out.

Lisa reluctantly walks towards Mr. Furbles. And awkwardly
kneels on the floor to get closer to him.

LISA (cont'd)
(whispering)
So, Mr. Furbles. Is there any way we
are getting out of this without
agreeing to getting tortured in hell
forever?

RUFUS FURBLES
Nope, sorry. No can do.

Mr. Furbles paces around the room, curiously inspecting it.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
Besides, there has to be something
y'all want.

He walks past Lisa, ignoring she's there. Suddenly, he stops
pacing and turns around abruptly to look up at Adam.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
How about you Adam?

Adam is startled.

ADAM
How do you-

RUFUS FURBLES
(interrupting)
How do I know your name? I know
everyone's name. We keep files of
everyone's deepest, shallowest...
(stops to think for a
second)
mediumest desires down at the office

Adam looks and Lisa confused. Mr. Furbles sees their faces
and lets out an exaggerated sigh.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
Everyone wants something they can't
get from their God of choice...

He takes a big step towards Adam.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
that's when we, the demons, come in.

He gestures theatrically as he says "the demons," as if mocking the term.

Mr. Furbles leaps on the air mattress and from there to a dresser so that he is almost at eye level with Adam.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
You see, we get a bad rep. We are the bad guys... tortures and manipulators. Blah, blah, blah. But if you really think about it

He jumps on Adams shoulder. The boy is startled but does not look at the demon or say anything.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
We are the ones that actually show up for people.

He crosses his legs and looks down at Lisa, still kneeling on the floor.

How many times have you prayed to your "God" for help? Thousands probably, good church boy like you.

Adam finally looks at the little demon. Rufus pulls out a red lollipop out of nowhere and puts it in his mouth. He looks at Adam again.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
How many times has he been there for you?
(making a circle with his index and thumb)
Zeeeeero... How many times have you called me for help?

He decidedly puts up one finger.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
(chuckles)
Hell, not even one, technically. And I. Am. Here. I'm here for you, kid. And I'm trying to make all your dreams come true.

Adam swallows sternly but says nothing.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
Think about it... All the awards...
Sipping champagne with Zendaya.

Mr. Furbles looks at Lisa, then at Adam. He pulls out a pen.

RUFUS FURBLES (cont'd)
All you have to do is sign the little
dotted line, Adam.

Adam's eyes are now glassy. He feels his mouth start to
water like he just saw the world's best burger after a week
of starving. He locks eyes with Mr. Furbles for a few
seconds. The little demon smiles.

ADAM
(hesitant)
I'm- I'm not making a deal with the
devil.

Mr. Furbles throws his arms in the air.

RUFUS FURBLES
Oh, c'mon! Don't even think about it
like that. Think of me as... as a
fairy godmother, or the genie from
that Disney movie. Everyone likes
him. Besides, think about your mama.
She will be so proud of her boy. You
won't be a failure anymore.

Adam looks at Lisa with watery eyes.

LISA
Adam, what are you thinking?

ADAM
Do you see any other way out of this?

LISA
But... It was just a joke, I-

Rufus Furbles jumps to the floor. He now stands between the
two teens. He looks at Lisa and smiles. He balances his pen
on his finger.

RUFUS FURBLES
(singing)
Dreams waiting to come true here...

Adam goes to reach for the pen. Lisa stands up and pushes
Adam out of the room into the bathroom. She blocks the door
with a chair.

- a. push Adam out of the way. sign contract
- b. let Adam sign

LISA

You said it, Adam. It's my mess.

Mr. Furbles claps loudly once and laughs.

RUFUS FURBLES

That's my girl! Alright, so, what are
you getting, sweetheart?

Lisa looks down at the demon and takes a deep breath.

The end.

Ending #3:
Lisa goes w Mr.
Furbles

Ending #4:
Adam goes w Mr.
Furbles